TIMBALLO ALLA TERAMANA

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
Central	**6-8**	**4 h**

INGREDIENTS

750 g	Eggs, for the crepes
711 g	Milk, for the crepes
42 g	Olive oil, for the crepes, plus more for the pan
119 g	00 flour
quantity not given	Nutmeg, for the crepe batter
5.5 g	Salt, for the crepe batter
84 g	Olive oil, for the filling
675 g	Ground beef
quantity not given	Nutmeg, for the beef
10 g	Garlic, finely chopped
342 g	Baby spinach leaves, loosely packed
300 g	Eggs, for the sauce
178 g	Milk, for the sauce
397 g	Tomato passata or simple red sauce
quantity not given	Salt
quantity not given	Black pepper
60 g	Butter
28 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
454 g	Mozzarella, one large ball cut into ¼-inch cubes

METHOD

1. Whisk the eggs, milk and 42 g olive oil together in a large bowl.
2. In a second bowl, stir the flour with the salt and 22 gratings of nutmeg. Pour the egg mixture in and whisk until smooth. Cover and refrigerate 30 minutes.
3. Lay parchment paper over a sheet pan and set it nearby.
4. Set an 8-inch nonstick saute pan over medium-low heat. Oil a paper towel lightly and wipe it round the pan.
5. Stir the rested batter well. Pour 45 g into the pan, then swirl the pan so the batter covers the base in one even layer and climbs just slightly up the sides. Give it 10 to 15 seconds, until the underside is faintly golden and small bubbles break on top. Flip it with a large spatula and cook another 10 to 15 seconds. Only the edges should take any color. Lay the crepe flat on the lined pan and cover it with a sheet of parchment.
6. Work through the remaining batter the same way. Expect 35 to 40 crepes.
7. For the filling, set a large saute pan over medium-high heat with 42 g of the olive oil. Add the beef and break it apart with a spatula or wooden spoon, then cook it to a light brown, 8 to 10 minutes. Grate in about 15 gratings of nutmeg, then season with salt and pepper. Tip it into a bowl to cool.
8. Wipe the pan out and return it to low heat. Add the remaining 42 g olive oil and the garlic and cook 10 to 15 seconds, until fragrant but not colored. Add the spinach and wilt it, 1 to 2 minutes. Season with salt, then spread it on a sheet pan or plate to cool.
9. Drain the cooled spinach, turn it onto a kitchen towel and wring out the water. Chop it fine and stir it through the beef.
10. For the sauce, whisk the eggs and milk together, then whisk in the passata or the simple red sauce. Season with salt and pepper.
11. Set the oven to 350°F.
12. Take a 9 by 13-inch baking dish, line it with parchment and rub 1 Tbsp of the butter over the paper.
13. Spread 140 g of the sauce over the base as evenly as you can. Lay 11 or 12 crepes across it, overlapping them and letting the edges drape up and over the rim of the dish.
14. Build the first layer with 140 g sauce, 160 g of the beef and spinach, 6 g parmigiano, 15 g butter and 90 g mozzarella, spreading each as evenly as you can. Cover it with about 4 crepes. Build four more layers the same way, then finish with a last layer of crepes. Fold the overhanging edges in over the top.
15. Cover with foil and bake 20 to 30 minutes. Pull the foil off and bake on until golden brown, another 20 to 30 minutes. Let it stand 15 to 20 minutes.
16. Once it is cool enough to handle, set a sheet pan or large flat platter over the dish, then turn the whole thing over

onto it. Lift the dish off and peel the parchment away.

17. Cut into squares and divide between plates.

NOTES

A timballo is named for the vessel, not the dish. The Teramo version swaps sheets of pasta for crespelle, paper-thin crepes, and builds a dozen or more layers.

Keep each layer thin and resist adding an extra scoop of beef or a heavier smear of sauce. The flavor accumulates across all the layers rather than within any one of them.

Wring the wilted spinach out in a towel before it joins the beef. Water left in it ends up in the layers.

The crepe yield is deliberately generous to cover breakage. Spare crepes can be filled with parmigiano or pecorino and covered with brodo for crespelle in brodo.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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